Akanksha Pandey

Product Designer (UI/UX) | FinTech | Growth Design
Bengaluru, India | Available to join immediately | akankshapandeyy04@gmail.com | +91 8707524462
Portfolio: akplancer.github.io | LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/akankshapandey4

Summary

Product designer with ~2 years in B2C fintech (retail algo trading), focused on growth design: onboarding, activation, subscriptions and referrals. Redesigned strategy discovery to lift first-session activation by 20%, and designed a referral programme that now accounts for ~30% of new sign-ups. Uses AI across the design workflow, from competitive analysis to microcopy.

Experience

Returns Wealth (Optibase Financial Technologies Pvt. Ltd.)

Early-stage algo-trading platform
Product Designer | Sep 2025 – Sep 2026
Design Intern (promoted to full-time) | Mar 2025 – Aug 2025

- Redesigned algo discovery with personalized filters, search and clearer strategy cards, lifting the share of new users who activated within 5 minutes of sign-up by 20%.
- Simplified retail algo trading for first-time investors with a 60-second onboarding flow that takes them from sign-up to activation.
- Owned subscription and multi-stage upgrade journeys end to end, personalised by plan state and lifecycle stage.
- Led the referral programme end to end, from user research to developer handoff; referrals now account for ~30% of new sign-ups.
- Designed the notification system and notification preference settings for the platform's two revenue-generating features, trade recommendations and algo trading, including segmented messages across in-app, WhatsApp and Telegram.
- Created Returns Academy, an in-app learning feature with courses on finance and trading for retail investors.
- Used AI (ChatGPT, Claude, Spline, Stitch) across nearly every project for brainstorming, competitive analysis, first drafts, microcopy, documentation and visual editing.
- Built reusable components for the Figma design system and defined the app's visual language, working with PMs, engineers and compliance to balance user needs, business goals and regulatory requirements.

Indriya (Aditya Birla Group's jewellery brand)

Design Research & Strategy Intern | Jan 2024 – Jun 2024

- Conducted field user research on customer preferences and retail behaviour across Bihar, West Bengal and Gujarat, and synthesised the insights into market-specific collections launched in Bihar and Gujarat.

Education

Bachelor of Design (B.Des), Fashion & Lifestyle Accessory Design | National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT), Kolkata | 2024

Skills

Design: Interaction design, visual design, prototyping, design systems, information architecture, mobile app design (iOS/Android)
Research & Growth: User research, onboarding, activation, conversion optimisation, retention, referral programmes
Tools: Figma, FigJam, Framer, Jira, AI prototyping (Figma Make, Lovable, v0)
Domain: FinTech, investing, algo trading, B2C consumer apps, regulated products